Q+A

Voice for Change

Zeenat Aman *talks about lending her iconic voice to* Embers of Hope, *a new environmental documentary series showing on Discovery and Animal Planet channels*



Q. Why did you feel it was important to lend your voice to the battle against climate change?

It's an existential issue that impacts every single one of us! Of course, more vulnerable communities, the ones who are least responsible for this mess, are the first to bear its brunt, but the crisis is global.

Q. How aware were you of climate change and its impact before you signed up for *Embers of Hope*?

I had general awareness, but *Embers of Hope* has given me a deeper understanding of it. More importantly, it has given me insight into the lives of ordinary people doing extraordinary thing to confront these challenges.

Q. Have you made any changes in your personal life to tackle climate change or other environmental issues?

I have to say that I think what is required is institutional and political change. That's the only thing that can actually bring the scale of impact that is required. But yes, at an individual level, I have really cut down on foreign travels that demand long flights, as well as become restrained in my buying habits.

Q. Are there any other causes you espouse?

Animal welfare is very close to my heart. I'm also keen to speak more about domestic violence issues in the country.

—with Amit Dixit

Photograph: **PTI**